

Yun Yue Zhao, CPA

REAL ESTATE FINANCE · BUILT FOR THE INVESTMENT SIDE

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A real estate finance professional moving toward the investment side, with an auditor's discipline and an investor's eye. Five years in audit across investment funds and banking at Plante Moran and PwC, a buy-side semiconductor research desk in Tokyo, and fund controllership and reporting for an institutional real estate platform at Deloitte. I build my own models, from three-statement REIT work to DCF and NAV, and the automation that sits on top of them. CPA (California and Colorado), MBA, CFA Level III Candidate (Private Markets).

EXPERIENCE

Senior Consultant, Finance Transformation (Real Estate Finance Operate)

Dec 2025 – Present

Deloitte Consulting LLP · Costa Mesa, California

- Contribute to fund controllership and reporting for the real estate platform of one of the largest U.S. banks and asset managers: NAV preparation, fund-level reporting, intercompany reconciliations, and capital call and distribution mechanics across four funds and more than 20 assets spanning core through development strategies.
- Help diagnose and redesign recurring finance processes, and develop the materials for the steering committees governing the transformation roadmap.
- Scoped 12 AI and automation use cases across real estate finance and built implementation plans for 4 prioritized initiatives, bringing an audit-grounded controls perspective to how those tools are designed and governed.

Hedge Fund Intern, Semiconductor Equity Research

Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

Asian Technology Advisors · Tokyo, Japan

- Covered 10 companies across the semiconductor supply chain, worth more than \$8 trillion in combined market value, from chip designers and foundries (Nvidia, TSMC, Broadcom) to the memory, equipment, and component makers around them (Micron, Lam Research, Murata).
- Built and maintained 6 valuation models using DCF, trading multiples, and scenario analysis, and wrote 6 coverage notes that fed the thesis updates and portfolio reviews of 3 senior analysts and portfolio managers.
- Worked through 12 earnings calls across two earnings seasons alongside filings and sell-side research, tracking the AI infrastructure capex cycle at the chip level and the data-center demand it now drives across digital-infrastructure real estate.

Senior Associate, Audit (Banking & Capital Markets)

Sep 2021 – Oct 2023

PwC · Denver, Colorado

- As in-charge senior, owned the substantive testing of the highest-risk line items for banking and capital markets clients across credit, real estate lending, and structured finance: loan confirmations, the allowance for credit losses (CECL), and collateral valuations.
- Ran a delivery team of more than 20 across India and Argentina through a 24-hour cycle, reviewing the work to a single standard before partner review.
- Rebuilt manual reconciliation into reproducible pipelines using Alteryx and PwC's Digital Lab tooling, cutting about 20% of the effort from each engagement.

Audit Senior, Investment Fund Practice

Jan 2019 – Sep 2021

Plante Moran PLLC · Denver, Colorado

- Ran investment fund audit engagements across real estate, private equity, and alternative investment funds end to end, including substantive testing of capital account roll-forwards, management fee and carried interest calculations, distribution waterfalls, and side letter compliance.
- Performed fair value testing under ASC 820 across real estate and alternative holdings, reviewing independent appraisal methodologies, cap rate and discount rate assumptions, and the unrealized gains and losses that drive fund NAV.
- Supervised three junior staff, drafted engagement budgets in the \$100K–\$300K range, delivered 100% of audit reports on time, and carried manager-level work on select engagements before holding the title.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- REIT valuation model:** Three-statement model with NAV and FFO/AFFO, grounded in a public data-center REIT's 10-K (Excel).
- Data center & digital-infrastructure thesis:** Macro and bottom-up analysis linking the AI chip-capex cycle to hyperscaler data-center demand and the real estate it underwrites.
- Reconciliation auto-matching tool:** Python tool that matches intercompany reconciliations and flags exceptions; shipped and live on Streamlit.

EDUCATION

MBA Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan

2023 – 2025

Master of Accountancy University of Denver, Denver, CO

2016 – 2018

B.S. Biochemistry University of Washington, Seattle, WA (Dean's List)

2011 – 2015

CREDENTIALS, SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Licenses: CPA (California and Colorado) · CFA Level III Candidate (Private Markets) · Real Estate Broker License

Modeling & Data: Advanced Excel (incl. VBA) · DCF / NAV · three-statement modeling · Yardi (Asset Mgmt & Fund Accounting) · Bloomberg Terminal · Capital IQ

Automation & AI: Python (working) · Alteryx · Microsoft Copilot · generative-AI-assisted analysis · Tableau · Power BI

Certifications: Project Management & AI for Manager (Microsoft) · Data Wrangling, Visualization & Insight Knowledge Badge (PwC)

Languages: English (Native/Bilingual) · Mandarin Chinese (Native/Bilingual) · Japanese (Limited Working)